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threat is directly ahead of them, so this device works," says Mehta, who adds that it comes with a military grade laptop from which the device can operate. Creating the product was no easy feat. It took the team three years of hard work to get it right. "This is a very complicated system that involves interaction between various components, plus aerospace challenges," says Mehta. The product could be priced anywhere between Rs 10 lakh and Rs 1 crore depending on the configuration.

This start-up has also devised

other alternative energy solutions based on human power. One is a phone charger that can either be wound up by hand or rolled on to material, such as jeans. "The rotation movement pumps energy into the phone and converts it into electrical energy," says Mehta. In cranking mode, one minute of winding produces up to five minutes of talk time and 40 minutes on standby while in rolling mode. One minute of rolling produces one minute of talk time. It produces three watts of electrical energy. So far, 10,000 chargers have been sold online for Rs 350, mainly in urban and semi-urban areas. Now the team is looking at partners who can push it into rural areas. "This is very relevant even in semi-urban areas

where there are sometimes power cuts for up to 16 hours. You don't need electricity to charge your phone," says Mehta. To help market, sell and operate both products, MBA graduate Vipul Joshi, 27, and IIT-B graduate and aerospace expert Amardeep Singh, 24, have joined the company.

The journey for the founding trio started in IIT where they were constantly brimming with ideas. Electrical engineering student Bhat dominated a national autonomous robotics competition for four years. His electronics skills have been crucial in the design of Netra, which is electronics heavy. Mechanical engineer Singh was fascinated by hovering platforms and was an event manager for IIT's cultural festivals as well as the

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THEY HAVE ALSO MADE A CELLPHONE CHARGER THAT WORKS BY HAND WINDING OR RUBBING AGAINST FABRIC.

Techfest. Mehta says his enthusiasm for technology, particularly perpetual motion systems, was planted at an early age. The unmanned aerial device won the prestigious MAV 2008 (Micro Aerial Vehicle) competition in the hovering category, organised by the National Aerospace Laboratories (CSIR), Aerial Delivery Research and Development Establishment (DRDO) and India and US Army RDECOM (International Technology Center-Pacific). "This really gave us the impetus to push it on a commercial scale," says Mehta. "We were always discussing how technological products could be made better. We all share a passion for delivering products that add value and are simple so they can make a difference to people's lives," says Mehta. Now, they'll have to see if their optimism can be optimised. ■